Cardiology Service Line Handbook

MERIDIAN HEALTH PARTNERS ## Department of Cardiology: Service Line Handbook Document ID: MHP-CARDSLH-042 Effective Date: 1 January 2026 Applicability: All Meridian Health Partners sites (Sites 01 through 14) Author: Dr. Aris Thorne, Operations Policy Lead

SECTION 1: PURPOSE AND SCOPE 1.1 This handbook establishes operational standards, patient scheduling parameters, and insurance coverage matrices for the Cardiology department across all 14 Meridian Health Partners outpatient facilities.

1.2 Referral turnaround times are governed exclusively by the Meridian Referral Management Policy (MHP-REF-001). Staff shall consult that policy for intake validation timelines and shall not apply separate turnaround standards within this department.

SECTION 2: APPOINTMENT SCHEDULING AND COMMITMENTS 2.1 First Appointment Availability: The Cardiology department commits that every accepted referral shall be offered an initial appointment within 7 days of referral receipt.

2.2 Appointment Durations: Departmental services are allocated fixed schedule blocks. The standard durations are defined as follows:

* Cardiology Consultation (CARD-CONS): 30 minutes.
* Echocardiogram (CARD-ECHO): 45 minutes.
* Cardiac Catheterisation (CARD-CATH): 90 minutes.

SECTION 3: CONDITIONS ACCEPTED AND EXPLICITLY NOT ACCEPTED 3.1 Accepted Conditions: The Cardiology department accepts adult patients presenting with suspected or established chronic coronary artery disease, valvular heart disease, uncomplicated arrhythmias, hypertension requiring specialist evaluation, and heart failure managed in an outpatient setting.

3.2 Explicitly Not Accepted Conditions: The department does not accept patients presenting with acute ST-elevation myocardial infarction (STEMI), unstable angina requiring immediate emergency intervention, decompensated cardiogenic shock, or pediatric cardiology cases under the age of 18 years. Such presentations must be redirected immediately to a hospital emergency department.

SECTION 4: PATIENT PREPARATION INSTRUCTIONS 4.1 Cardiology Consultation (CARD-CONS): Patients must bring a valid government-issued photo ID, their current insurance card, a complete list of all active medications with dosages, and prior electrocardiogram (ECG) reports generated within the preceding 12 months, if available.

4.2 Echocardiogram (CARD-ECHO): Patients are instructed to wear a two-piece outfit to facilitate unhindered chest wall access. There are no fluid or dietary restrictions unless co-scheduled with a concurrent diagnostic test.

4.3 Cardiac Catheterisation (CARD-CATH): Patients must observe a strict nil-per-os (NPO) status, consuming nothing by mouth (including water, gum, and mints) for 6 hours prior to the scheduled procedure time. Patients must arrange for a responsible adult driver aged 18 or older to transport them home post-procedure; solo departures via public transit or taxi are strictly prohibited.

SECTION 5: PROCEDURE LIST PRICES, PLAN COVERAGE, AND PRE-AUTHORISATION MATRIX 5.1 The following matrix governs billing codes, list prices, plan coverage, and pre-authorisation requirements across Meridian Health Partners' four designated insurance plans: MERIDIAN-GOLD, MERIDIAN-SILVER, MERIDIAN-BRONZE, and CIVIC-BASE.

5.1.1 Cardiology Consultation (CARD-CONS) * List Price: $220 * Duration: 30 minutes * MERIDIAN-GOLD: Covered; no pre-authorisation required. * MERIDIAN-SILVER: Covered; no pre-authorisation required. * MERIDIAN-BRONZE: Covered; no pre-authorisation required. * CIVIC-BASE: Covered; no pre-authorisation required.

5.1.2 Echocardiogram (CARD-ECHO) * List Price: $950 * Duration: 45 minutes * MERIDIAN-GOLD: Covered; no pre-authorisation required. * MERIDIAN-SILVER: Covered; pre-authorisation required in 3 business days. * MERIDIAN-BRONZE: Covered; pre-authorisation required in 5 business days. * CIVIC-BASE: Covered; pre-authorisation required in 5 business days.

5.1.3 Cardiac Catheterisation (CARD-CATH) * List Price: $7,800 * Duration: 90 minutes * MERIDIAN-GOLD: Covered; pre-authorisation required in 2 business days. * MERIDIAN-SILVER: Covered; pre-authorisation required in 3 business days. * MERIDIAN-BRONZE: Covered; pre-authorisation required in 5 business days. * CIVIC-BASE: Not covered.